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Drum, hand drum, frame drum

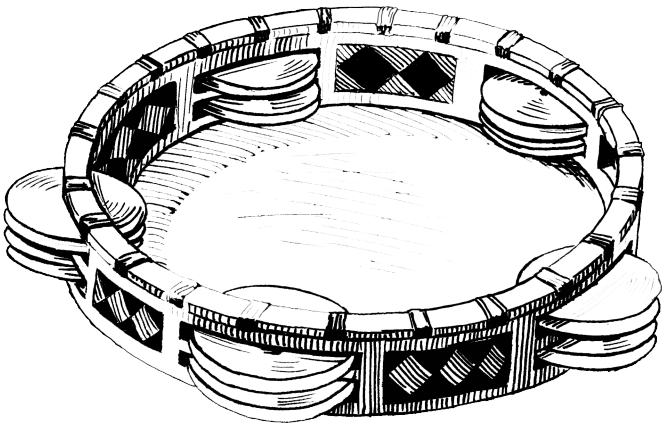
7.4.6 Drum, hand drum, frame drum

References:

Hebrew תֹּף, תפף (tof, tafaf (verb)) GEN 31:27, EXO 15:20, EXO 15:20, JDG 11:34, 1SA 10:5, 1SA 18:6, 2SA 6:5, 1CH 13:8, JOB 21:12, PSA 68:26, PSA 81:3, PSA 149:3, PSA 150:4, ISA 5:12, ISA 24:8, ISA 30:32, JER 31:4

Greek τύμπανον (tumpanon) JDT 3:7, JDT 16:1, 1MA 9:39, 1ES 5:2

Description:



Timbrel or tambourine or hand drum (musical instrument) (© Public Domain - Wikimedia Commons)The drum consisted of a membrane, usually of animal skin, which was stretched over a shallow circular, triangular, or square frame.

Usage:

The drum was struck sharply with one or two hands, depending on where it was situated. It could be held in the left hand, under the left arm, or against the chest and struck with the right hand, or it could be held on the knees or the ground and struck with one or two hands. The fingers of the left hand could be used to tighten or loosen the tension on the membrane as it was struck with the palm of the right hand.

Translation:

Women beating hand drums (Gary Todd, Israel Museum, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons)The use of the Hebrew word *tof* is usually associated with singing, processions, and festivals. Archaeological evidence indicates that drums with metal circlets on the frame ("tambourines" or "timbrels") were not known in biblical times. As a general rule, the best translation for this word will be "hand drum" or simply "drum." tion for this word will be "hand drum" or simply "drum."